



pathfinder
PATHFINDER

Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation

Deliverable D4.1

EDS + Research Agenda and Action Plan for Slovakia

Európsky dialóg

29 July 2026

EVENT DESCRIPTION SHEET

PROJECT			
Participant:	1 – Európsky dialóg (ED)		
PIC number:	937013405		
Project name and acronym:	Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation — PATHFINDER		
EVENT DESCRIPTION			
Event number:	WP4		
Event name:	Participatory research in Slovakia		
Type:	Mutual Learning Event		
In situ/online:	In situ		
Location:	Trnava, Slovakia — Juraj Fándly Library (Knížnica Juraja Fándlyho v Trnave)		
Date(s):	Friday, 3 July 2026		
Website(s) (if any):	N/A		
Participants			
Female:	17		
Male:	16		
Non-binary:	0		
Countries represented:	Slovakia (14), Romania (5), Lithuania (5), Portugal (5), Italy (4)		
Total number of participants:	33	From total number of countries:	5
Description			
<i>Short description of the event and its activities.</i>			
The Slovak National Participatory Event, organised under WP4 and titled “AI and the Future of Work — A Youth Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence and Employment in Slovakia”, took place on Friday 3 July 2026 at the Juraj Fándly Library in Trnava (Knížnica Juraja Fándlyho v Trnave), Slovakia, as the national participatory dialogue foreseen within the PATHFINDER project. The event was organised by Európsky dialóg, the project coordinator, and brought together 33 participants (young people aged 18–30 together with a number of employers and working professionals) to examine how Artificial Intelligence (AI) is reshaping access to employment, the skills the labour market now demands, and which young people risk being left behind as these changes accelerate. Seventeen participants were women and sixteen men, and five countries of residence were represented: Slovakia (14), Romania (5), Lithuania (5), Portugal (5) and Italy (4). Participants included university students, psychologists, a librarian, a university teacher, a UX/UI designer, marketing and digital-account professionals, a civil servant and an employer. This cross-national composition gave the Slovak dialogue a distinctly European character, allowing shared concerns about AI and youth employment to be examined alongside nationally specific experiences. The event was prepared by the Európsky dialóg team in the weeks following the close of the baseline survey. The Juraj Fándly Library was selected as the venue because a public library is a neutral, freely accessible civic space rather than an institutional or corporate one. Recruitment ran through Európsky dialóg’s national youth and civil-society networks and through contacts in universities and youth organisations, and was extended to young people from other EU Member States present in Slovakia at the time, which produced the mixed-nationality composition described above. Participants registered in advance, and on arrival each signed an attendance and consent sheet covering photography, audiovisual recording and the use of personal data, in line with the project’s GDPR protocol; all 33 participants gave that consent. The organisers prepared the working materials in advance: a national findings presentation summarising			

the baseline survey results (Annex 5.3), printed World Café discussion cards carrying the guiding questions for each thematic table (Annex 5.4), flipchart sheets and note templates for the table facilitators, and refreshments for the break. The event was run in English so that all participants could take part on equal terms, with Slovak used at the tables where it helped.

The event was designed on the basis of PATHFINDER's common Phase 1 Research Framework, which adopts a Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR) approach: a collaborative, cyclical process of planning, action and reflection in which young people act as co-researchers investigating the structural conditions that shape their own working lives. The methodological design draws on established participatory research traditions, operationalised through the project's shared research framework and event concept note so that every partner country ran a comparable process. The World Café format was chosen for the central activity because it allows a room to build collective knowledge progressively: each small group inherits, challenges and extends what the previous groups recorded, so the notes from the fourth rotation carry the accumulated reasoning of all of them. Facilitators were briefed against the same framework, and the four thematic tables, the guiding questions on the discussion cards and the sequence of activities were close to those used by the partners in Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Greece and Serbia, so that the Slovak material is directly comparable with theirs.

The participatory dialogue constituted the qualitative component of the Slovak research process and complemented the common baseline survey administered among young people aged 18–30 and employers across the PATHFINDER partner countries prior to the national dialogues. The survey, implemented in national languages using a shared questionnaire, generated comparable evidence on AI awareness and use, perceptions of AI and employment, preparedness, skills needs and priorities for future action. Rather than treating these findings as final conclusions, the event provided a structured space in which participants could collectively interpret the survey results, test them against their own experience, and identify the priority issues requiring further research and policy attention, closing the action-research loop of data, reflection and action that distinguishes PATHFINDER's approach from a conventional survey-plus-workshop design.

The programme followed the sequential logic of the common methodology. Registration, welcome and consent were followed by an introduction to the PATHFINDER project and a presentation of the baseline survey findings, which established a shared evidence base and surfaced the first lines of disagreement. The central activity was the World Café, organised around four thematic tables mirrored across all partner countries: AI and the Changing Workplace; Skills for the AI Era; Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind; and Education and Training Gaps. Small mixed-nationality groups rotated through all four tables, each group building on the notes of those before it, with a facilitator remaining at each table to guide discussion, summarise earlier contributions and document recurring themes. A root-cause discussion then pushed the groups beyond immediate symptoms toward underlying structural conditions, a prioritisation round identified the challenges the room considered most urgent, and a closing collective reflection validated the priorities that inform the Slovak Research Agenda and Action Plan presented in this report.

Outputs were captured at group rather than individual level, in line with the project's GDPR protocol: facilitators secured consent for note-taking, table notes were photographed and transcribed, and participation was recorded through anonymous counts. The full set of table notes is transcribed in Annex 5.5 and the original photographed sheets are archived in the WP4 project records. The process generated qualitative evidence that both validated and expanded the baseline survey findings, positioning young people not as an audience but as active contributors to the interpretation of evidence and the co-creation of recommendations. Beyond its research objectives, the event strengthened participants' awareness of AI's implications for their own working lives and demonstrated the value of participatory, democratic approaches to navigating technological change — directly informing the Slovak Research Agenda and Action Plan and contributing to PATHFINDER's wider comparative research across the partner countries.

Version / Revision History

Version	Date	Author / Organisation	Description of changes
0.1	20/07/2026	Európsky dialóg	First draft
0.2	27/07/2026	Európsky dialóg	Internal review
1.0	31/07/2026	Európsky dialóg	Final version submitted

Acknowledgement

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Disclaimer

Views and opinions expressed are however those of the author only and do not necessarily reflect those of the European Union or the European Education and Culture Executive Agency (EACEA). Neither the European Union nor the granting authority can be held responsible for them.

Summary

This report presents the findings of the Slovak participatory research conducted under Work Package 4 (WP4): Participatory research in Slovakia of the PATHFINDER project, Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation. The research examined how Artificial Intelligence (AI) is shaping young people's transition to employment, and the opportunities, risks and skills that will determine whether that transition is inclusive.

The research adopted a mixed-methods participatory approach, combining the common PATHFINDER baseline survey with a structured participatory dialogue built around the World Café methodology. Young people rotated through four thematic tables: AI and the Changing Workplace; Skills for the AI Era; Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind; and Education and Training Gaps. Interpreting the survey evidence, sharing lived experience and jointly identifying the priorities that inform the Slovak Research Agenda and Action Plan.

The findings show that young people regard AI as a transformative force well beyond the tools themselves. AI is valued for learning, productivity and new kinds of work, yet the same conversations raised job displacement, deepening inequality, environmental cost and a fear of over-reliance. In the Slovak national sample, familiarity and regular use of AI are effectively universal, yet only a fifth of respondents feel very prepared for an AI-driven labour market and scepticism that AI will create opportunities for young people runs deeper than anywhere else in the consortium. The strongest single message of the dialogue was the distinction between using AI and understanding it: confidence, critical judgement and genuine AI literacy lag well behind everyday use. Participants located the risk of exclusion in structural conditions such as rural location, low income, family circumstances and weaker schools, rather than individual effort, and judged that responsibility for responding is shared across schools, employers, public institutions, the EU and young people themselves.

On this evidence the report sets out a Slovak Research Agenda identifying priority themes for further investigation, and a Slovak Action Plan proposing practical measures to embed AI literacy and human-centred skills in education, repair the pathway between education and real work experience, and widen access for the young people most at risk of being left behind. The report contributes to PATHFINDER's wider objectives, feeding the project's transnational synthesis, Youth Skills Labs, national public debate and final policy recommendations.

Table of Contents

Version / Revision History.....	4
Acknowledgement.....	4
Disclaimer.....	4
Summary.....	5
1. Introduction	7
1.1 Participatory research overview	7
1.2 Objectives	7
1.3 Baseline survey	7
1.4 Participatory dialogue event design	8
2. Main Findings.....	9
2.1 Key themes	9
2.2 Youth perspectives and lived experiences	9
2.3 Employer perspectives	10
3. Slovak Research Agenda & Action Plan	11
3.1 Slovak-specific key findings	11
3.2 Slovak Research Agenda.....	11
3.3 Slovak Action Plan for youth-centred change	12
4. Conclusions	15
5. Annexes	16
5.1 Event agenda	16
5.2 Event photos.....	17
5.3 National findings presentation	18
5.4 World Café theme cards.....	20
5.5 World Café notes	21
5.6 Baseline survey instrument — Youth.....	23
5.7 Baseline survey instrument — Employers.....	27
5.8 Selected responses — Youth survey	30
5.9 Selected responses — Employer survey	32

1. Introduction

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is transforming labour markets and reshaping the skills that a successful transition to employment now requires. As these changes accelerate, there is a growing need to ensure that young people are equipped to navigate them, and that the transition is inclusive, ethical and human-centred rather than one that widens the gaps it inherits.

This report presents the Slovak participatory research carried out under WP4 of the PATHFINDER project. It brings together the evidence of the common baseline survey and the national participatory dialogue to examine how young people in Slovakia and their peers across Europe understand AI and employment, and it sets out the Slovak Research Agenda and Action Plan that translate that evidence into priorities for research and practice.

1.1 Participatory research overview

PATHFINDER treats young people not as passive recipients of labour-market policy but as knowledgeable actors, capable of interpreting their own experience and contributing to evidence-based responses. This reflects the project's Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR) design, a collaborative and cyclical process of planning, action and reflection that aims not only to generate knowledge but to build the critical awareness and agency of those taking part. The approach draws on the established traditions of participatory action research, critical pedagogy and experiential learning.

Because PATHFINDER spans several countries with different labour markets and levels of AI adoption, the design deliberately pairs a standardised instrument which is the baseline survey with flexible participatory methods as the dialogue event. The combination buys comparability across countries and sensitivity to local realities at the same time. In Slovakia, the mixed-methods design combined the national baseline survey with a structured World Café dialogue, generating context-specific knowledge that underpins the Slovak Research Agenda and Action Plan while contributing to PATHFINDER's wider comparative work.

1.2 Objectives

The Slovak participatory research pursued six connected objectives, consistent with the PATHFINDER framework.

- To validate the baseline survey findings by examining how participants interpreted them and whether they matched their own experience of AI and labour-market change.
- To explore the implications of AI for employment and changing workplaces : how it reshapes work organisation, opportunity and the character of jobs.
- To identify the skills and competencies young people need for AI-supported labour markets, with particular attention to AI literacy, critical thinking and human-centred skills.
- To examine the risks of exclusion facing vulnerable groups of young people, and the conditions needed for a more inclusive transition.
- To generate evidence for the PATHFINDER Research Agenda by identifying priority themes grounded in lived experience.
- To strengthen dialogue between young people and, in later phases, employers and labour-market stakeholders, supporting mutual learning and the co-creation of recommendations.

1.3 Baseline survey

The baseline survey was the first stage of the research and provided its quantitative foundation. Two parallel questionnaires (one for young people aged 18–30 and one for employers) shared a common structure so that answers could be compared item by item across the awareness, perception, exposure, skills and priorities dimensions. Implemented online in national languages ahead of the dialogue events, the survey generated comparable evidence across the PATHFINDER partner countries: in total 207 young people and 144 employers responded across the consortium, establishing the empirical base against which each national dialogue was set.

Country	Partner	Youth	Employers
Bosnia and Herzegovina	CREDI	50	59
Bulgaria	PCO	69	25
Greece	SEERC / CITY ULE · Light Trees	24	19
Serbia	YRS	34	11
Slovakia	Európsky dialóg	30	30
Total		207	144

Baseline survey responses by partner country (final dataset).

In Slovakia the baseline collected 30 youth and 30 employer responses, each with full GDPR consent, gathered partly through the online questionnaire and partly in person and verbally around the dialogue event, using the same instrument in both channels. Reflecting the deliberately purposive character of PATHFINDER's sampling, the Slovak figures reported here are read as indicative national patterns and interpreted against the pooled consortium evidence; the participatory dialogue, not the survey alone, carries the weight of the Slovak-specific findings. The Slovak youth sample skews female (23 of 30) and toward the upper end of the age band (15 of 30 aged 26–30) — a skew the event recruitment deliberately compensated for by reaching a broader and more balanced mix of participants. The Slovak employer sample spans organisations of every size, from micro-organisations of fewer than ten staff (15 of 30) to large employers of 250 or more (4 of 30), and covers civil society, IT and digital, services, the creative industries, manufacturing and the public sector.

1.4 Participatory dialogue event design

The Slovak National Participatory Event was designed to complement the survey through a structured process in which young people jointly interpreted the evidence and identified shared priorities.

The principal activity was a World Café organised around four thematic tables: AI and the Changing Workplace, Skills for the AI Era, Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind, and Education and Training Gaps. Small groups rotated systematically through every table, so that each participant contributed to every theme while progressively building on the ideas recorded by earlier groups. Facilitators remained at each table to guide discussion, summarise previous contributions and document recurring themes and points of convergence. A root-cause discussion then pushed the groups past immediate symptoms toward the structural conditions underneath, and a collective reflection consolidated the priorities carried forward into this report.

2. Main Findings

The Slovak participatory research forms part of the first, evidence-generating stage of PATHFINDER, establishing the empirical base for the project's later activities which is the Youth Skills Lab in Slovakia, the national public debate on AI and the future of work, the transnational dialogue and the final policy recommendations. The findings below synthesise the baseline evidence with the qualitative material generated in the Slovak dialogue.

Across the consortium the baseline survey revealed a clear readiness gap. Familiarity with AI and everyday use are near-universal among young respondents — 94% at least somewhat familiar, 85% using AI weekly or more — yet only 17% feel very prepared for an AI-driven labour market and 77% have never taken part in AI-related training. Employers echoed the concern, with 91% rating young people's employability as low or moderate and 94% describing them as only moderately prepared or not prepared in the skills that matter, while 63% provided no AI or digital-skills training themselves.

The Slovak national responses sharpen this picture. Nearly every Slovak youth respondent is at least somewhat familiar with AI tools (29 of 30) and 87% use them weekly or more, yet only 23% feel very prepared for an AI-driven labour market and a third feel unprepared outright. Most strikingly, Slovak youth were among the most sceptical in the consortium that AI will create new opportunities for young people (a mean of 2.7 on a five-point scale — the only item in the Slovak survey to fall below the neutral midpoint), while agreeing that it will replace existing youth jobs and increase labour-market inequality (3.6 on both) and agreeing most strongly of all that it will demand new types of skills (3.9). Three in five reported having experienced circumstances that disadvantage them, most often geographical and economic; and while access to AI training was among the highest in the consortium (40%, against 23% pooled), that access has clearly not translated into confidence. Slovak employers were the most likely single group to expect that AI will change the skill requirements of hiring within five years (57%), and 97% rated young people as only moderately prepared or not prepared in the skills that matter. The dialogue took this readiness gap as its starting point and opened up the experience and structural factors underneath it.

2.1 Key themes

Four themes recurred across the four tables. First, AI is understood as a driver of transformation reaching well beyond the tools themselves — into education, work organisation, inequality and the environment — so that responding to it is not a technical problem but a societal one. Second, and most insistently, participants drew a sharp line between using AI and understanding it: daily use is widespread, but the capacity to question, verify and judge AI output is not, and it was this literacy, not access, that participants named as the real gap. Third, the risk of being left behind was located in structural conditions rather than individual shortcomings. Fourth, responsibility for responding was described as shared across many actors at once, never parked on young people alone.

2.2 Youth perspectives and lived experiences

Young participants approached AI with a balanced realism, holding its opportunities and its limits in the same view. AI was valued as a resource for learning, information and productivity, and several participants pointed to concrete gains — one described using AI to build the case study for an internship application; survey respondents described AI speeding up routine tasks and being actively provided by employers. But the benefits were consistently made conditional on the ability to use AI critically. The recurring message was that genuine

preparedness depends not on access to tools or frequency of use but on understanding how AI works, recognising its limits, and keeping the independent judgement to know when it should not be used at all.

“If AI gains consciousness, will it be on our side?”

That question, asked at the same table that was discussing job-market contraction, captures the mood well: less a fear of the technology failing than of it succeeding on someone else’s terms. Participants expected AI to change jobs more than simply destroy them, shifting people from doing a task to supervising the AI that does it — a “human in the loop.” Creative and artistic work was repeatedly named as most substitutable — in the Slovak survey, the creative industries tied with IT as the sector seen as most affected — while fields such as medicine were seen as improved rather than threatened. Alongside the optimism sat clear anxieties: a shrinking pool of entry-level jobs, a widening gap between those who can use AI well and those who cannot, the environmental cost of data centres, and a fear of “becoming inhuman” through over-reliance. Several participants also described an ethical double-bind: pushed by schools and employers to use AI, then told not to use it in hiring processes — with no one teaching them where the line runs.

Concerns about inequality were prominent and specific. Participants judged that where a young person comes from — rural or urban, richer or poorer family, stronger or weaker school — and how it shapes their ability to benefit from AI, and named rural young people, those from low-income or less-educated families, and minorities including Roma communities and people with disabilities as most exposed. The survey evidence points the same way: low-skilled youth were rated clearly the most at risk, and 60% of Slovak respondents reported disadvantaging circumstances of their own — geographical barriers (rural, remote or less-developed areas) the most frequently cited, followed by economic ones. The barriers they described compound one another: patchy access to devices and the internet, the need to earn rather than study, and under-supported teachers in weaker schools. Overall, young people saw AI neither as an inevitable threat nor a guaranteed fix, but as something whose outcome depends on continuous learning, responsible use and an education system that actually equips them.

2.3 Employer perspectives

The employer perspective in the Slovak research comes primarily from the employer strand of the baseline survey, supplemented by the employers and working professionals who took part in the dialogue itself; broader employer participation belongs to the later WP10 national public debate. The Slovak employer respondents span every organisation size and a spread of sectors such as civil society, IT and digital, services, the creative industries, manufacturing and the public sector, and 90% of them already use AI tools to some degree. They presented a picture consistent with the wider consortium: 90% rate young people’s employability as moderate or low, 97% describe them as only moderately prepared or not prepared in the skills that matter, 57% expect AI to change the skill requirements of hiring within five years, and they name motivation, experience and the mismatch between education and labour-market needs as the main challenges in employing young people. Notably, they are far from certain that this is already happening: 43% were unsure whether AI had yet changed youth hiring in their own organisation. Their most repeated worry, in their own words, was over-reliance: young people leaning on AI without the critical filter to catch its errors, and simple entry-level tasks, the traditional first rung of a career is being automated away.

Read together, the youth and employer accounts are complementary rather than opposed. Where young people emphasise access to learning and the competencies to navigate AI, employers emphasise workforce readiness and the structural adaptation of work itself. Both point to the same conclusion — that a successful

transition depends not on individual capability alone but on education systems, employers and public institutions adapting together — and both, notably, converge on education, ethics codes and critical thinking as the most important support for young people entering an AI-shaped labour market.

3. Slovak Research Agenda & Action Plan

The participatory research identified a set of priorities that should guide future research and youth-employment work in Slovakia. Building on the baseline evidence and the Slovak dialogue, the Research Agenda below sets out priority themes for further investigation, and the Action Plan translates the evidence into practical measures.

3.1 Slovak-specific key findings

Participants viewed AI as a catalyst for wider societal change rather than a narrow technological development affecting individual jobs. They connected it with education, work, public policy and inequality at once, and consistently argued that it should be guided by human-centred principles such as fairness, inclusion, judgement and not by efficiency alone.

The strongest Slovak-specific finding was that the central challenge is not access to AI but the capacity to use it well. The distinction between using AI and understanding it ran through every table, and the survey gives it a sharp national edge: Slovak youth combine some of the consortium's highest AI use and training access with its deepest scepticism about AI creating opportunities for them. Access, in other words, has run ahead of understanding and of trust. Participants also broadened the question beyond young people, arguing that teachers and institutions need to adapt just as much.

Finally, the dialogue showed that responsibility for preparing for AI-driven change cannot be assigned to any single actor. Participants consistently described it as shared across schools, ministries, employers, EU institutions, youth organisations and young people themselves and valued the dialogue itself as a mechanism for building the shared understanding that an inclusive transition requires.

	Key finding	Where it is addressed
1	AI is experienced as double-edged sword as its an opportunity and a threat at once starting with young people naming both efficiency and new roles, and job loss, inequality and over-reliance.	Research Agenda Theme 1; Action 1 (AI literacy in education).
2	The decisive gap is between using AI and understanding it and daily use is near-universal, but confidence, verification and judgement lag behind.	Research Agenda Theme 1; Action 1.
3	Risk is structural, rural, low-income and minority young people are seen as most exposed, through access, money and weaker schools.	Research Agenda Theme 2; Action 3 (targeted inclusion).
4	Education lags the labour market there's outdated content, a soft-skills gap, missing life/financial skills, and broken or exploitative internships.	Research Agenda Theme 3; Action 2 (work-experience pathways).
5	Responsibility is shared among schools, ministries, employers, EU institutions, youth organisations and young people themselves, not any single actor.	Slovak Action Plan (all actions); Conclusions.

3.2 Slovak Research Agenda

The following priority themes translate the Slovak findings into an agenda for further participatory investigation across the project cycle.

Priority Theme 1: From using AI to understanding it to strengthening youth preparedness

Research objective: To examine how education systems, employers and public institutions can move young people from everyday AI use toward genuine AI literacy, the critical thinking, verification and judgement an AI-shaped labour market requires.

Proposed methods / data sources:

- Follow-up participatory workshops with young people
- Interviews and focus groups with youth and employers
- Comparative analysis across PATHFINDER partner countries
- Review of emerging AI-literacy and curriculum practices

Key stakeholders: educational institutions, employers, public authorities, youth organisations and policymakers.

Youth role(s): Co-researchers, peer facilitators and contributors to the interpretation of findings.

Timeframe: Short to medium term.

Priority Theme 2: Reducing structural inequalities in access to AI opportunity

Research objective: To investigate how the structural barriers young people named (rural location, low income, family circumstance and weaker schools) shape access to AI-related education, training and work, and what inclusive measures reduce them.

Proposed methods / data sources:

- Participatory research with rural, low-income and minority young people
- Community consultations
- Comparative policy analysis of inclusion measures

Key stakeholders: young people facing disadvantage, educational institutions, employers, local authorities, civil-society organisations and policymakers.

Youth role(s): Peer researchers, community facilitators and co-creators of recommendations.

Timeframe: Medium term.

Priority Theme 3: Repairing the pathway between education and real work experience

Research objective: To explore how education-to-work pathways, curricula, soft-skills provision, life and financial skills, and internships can be reformed so that young people arrive in the labour market genuinely prepared, and to bring employer perspectives directly into the Slovak dialogue.

Proposed methods / data sources:

- Joint youth–employer dialogue events
- Stakeholder consultations with education providers and employers
- Analysis of internship and work-based-learning models
- Validation workshops

Key stakeholders: young people, employers, education and vocational providers, policymakers and civil-society organisations.

Youth role(s): Dialogue participants, co-researchers and contributors to policy recommendations.

Timeframe: Throughout the project cycle.

3.3 Slovak Action Plan for youth-centred change

Drawing on the evidence generated through the baseline survey and the participatory dialogue, the following Action Plan identifies practical actions to support a more inclusive, responsible and youth-centred AI-driven labour-market transition in Slovakia.

Action 1: Embed AI literacy and human-centred skills in education

Level	Local • National
Target groups	Schools, universities, vocational providers, teachers and young people
Resources / support needed	• AI-literacy and critical-thinking modules from school level onward • Teacher training in how to teach with and about AI • Soft-skills provision (communication, negotiation, emotional intelligence) • Partnerships between education providers and the tech sector
Timeline	Short to medium term
Indicators of change	• AI literacy addressed explicitly in curricula and non-formal provision • More young people able to question and verify AI output, not only use it • Teachers supported to integrate AI critically in their teaching

Action 2: Repair education-to-work pathways and work experience

Level	National
Target groups	Young people, education and vocational providers, employers and public authorities
Resources / support needed	• Paid, properly regulated internships with clear administrative coverage • Recognition of school- and university-based experience as work experience • Life and financial-skills provision (including basic tax and employment literacy) • Removal of unrealistic “years of experience” barriers from entry-level roles
Timeline	Medium term
Indicators of change	• Reduced exploitation in internships and work placements • Stronger alignment between what education teaches and what work requires • More young people entering employment with genuine, transferable experience

Action 3: Widen access for young people most at risk of being left behind

Level	Local • National
Target groups	Rural, low-income and minority young people, and those facing educational or geographical barriers
Resources / support needed	• Accessible learning opportunities and targeted outreach • Investment in devices, connectivity and community infrastructure • Stipends or scholarships and support for under-resourced schools • Community partnerships to reach those the survey under-reaches
Timeline	Medium term
Indicators of change	• Increased participation of underrepresented groups in AI-related learning • Improved access across regions, including rural areas • Barriers to participation identified and reduced through project activities

Action 4: Sustain youth–employer dialogue on AI and youth employment

Level	Local • National • European
Target groups	Young people, employers, policymakers, education institutions and civil-society organisations
Resources / support needed	• Regular dialogue events bringing youth and employers together • Dissemination activities and stakeholder networks • Mechanisms for youth participation in decision-making

Timeline	Throughout the project cycle
	• Continued multi-stakeholder participation in AI-related dialogue • New partnerships established through the project • Evidence from participatory research feeding later outputs and policy
Indicators of change	

4. Conclusions

The Slovak participatory research shows the value of combining quantitative evidence with participatory dialogue to understand the opportunities and risks that AI brings to youth employment. By setting the baseline evidence against the lived experience of young people, the research produced a rounded picture of AI-driven labour-market change while ensuring that those most affected helped to define the priorities for responding to it.

The findings make clear that preparedness for an AI-driven labour market reaches well beyond technical competence. Participants returned again and again to AI literacy, critical thinking, human-centred skills and continuous learning, and to the structural conditions (rural location, income, weaker schools) that decide who can benefit. The Slovak evidence adds a distinctive warning: even where use and training access are comparatively high, scepticism and a sense of unpreparedness can persist, because understanding and trust do not follow automatically from exposure. Participants insisted that responsibility is shared, and that education, employers and public institutions must adapt together if technological change is to support an inclusive transition rather than deepen the inequalities it inherits.

On this basis the Slovak Research Agenda identifies priority themes for further investigation, and the Action Plan translates the evidence into practical measures — embedding AI literacy and human-centred skills in education, repairing the pathway between education and real work experience, widening access for those most at risk, and sustaining youth–employer dialogue. Together these outputs feed the next phases of PATHFINDER, from the Slovak Youth Skills Lab and national public debate to the transnational dialogue and the project’s final policy recommendations.

More broadly, the Slovak research demonstrates how participatory, youth-centred and evidence-based approaches can support a more inclusive and responsible response to AI-driven change. Ensuring that young people are equipped to take part in an increasingly AI-enabled society confidently, critically and on fair terms.

5. Annexes

The following annexes provide the supporting materials used during the Slovak participatory research.

5.1 Event agenda



Kde je moje miesto v ére AI?

3. 7. 2026 | 9:00 - 13:00

Záhradná čítareň
Knížnice Juraja Fándlyho v Trnave

9:00 Príchod účastníkov, privítanie, občerstvenie

9:30 Začiatok, program podujatia, úvod do problematiky

10:00 **Prednáška o vývoji AI a jej vplyve na trh práce | Dr. Zábojník**

11:00 Predstavenie **Pathfinder** výskumu a ďalších krokov projektu

11:30 **World Café diskusia s mladými ľuďmi**

12:30 Vyhodnotenie World Café diskusných stolov

13:00 Záver podujatia, finálne slovo, občerstvenie

 Spolufinancovaný Európskou úniou

5.2 Event photos

The Slovak National Participatory Event, Juraj Fándly Library, Trnava, 3 July 2026. All participants gave written consent to the use of photographic material.



5.3 National findings presentation

Slides presented during the evidence-based framing block, summarising the baseline survey findings. The consortium totals shown on the slides are those available on the day of the event, before the Slovak dataset was finalised.



AI & the Youth Labour Market

National Event – Slovakia

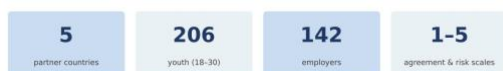
Phase 3 - Participatory Research - July 2026 - Euripsky dialóg (Coordinator)

PATHFINDER - National Event Slovakia - CERV 101253819

Funded by the European Union

OVERVIEW

The study at a glance



How we did it

A common baseline survey was fielded to youth and employers in each country, in the national language, ahead of today's participatory dialogue events. All responses were mapped to one shared schema so results are directly comparable across countries.

Seven themes we asked about

- Awareness & use of AI
- Perceptions of AI and jobs
- Who is most at risk
- Skills, preparedness & barriers
- Employer hiring experience
- What to do — and by whom

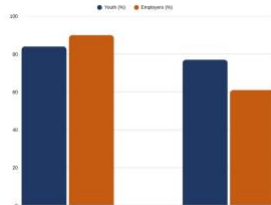
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THEME 2 - THE READINESS PARADOX

The gap nobody owns

Youth and employers agree on the problem. 84% of youth feel not (or only somewhat) prepared; 90% of employers rate youth employability only low or moderate.

But nobody closes it. 77% of youth have had no AI training — and 61% of employers provide none either.



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WHAT THIS MEANS FOR SLOVAKIA

Bringing the findings home



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THE PROJECT

About PATHFINDER

PATHFINDER - Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation - is a participatory research project working with marginalised youth (18-30) on AI literacy and employment transitions, across five countries.

Programme CERV 2025 - Citizens' Engagement

Grant agreement 101253819

Duration April 2026 - March 2028

Coordinator Euripsky dialóg (Slovakia)

Six partners, five countries

Euripsky dialóg (ED) Slovakia COORDINATOR	CREDI Bosnia & Herzegovina
SEERC / CITY ULE Greece	Light Trees Greece
PCO Bulgaria	YRS Serbia

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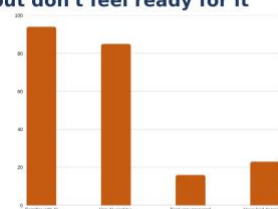
THEME 1 - EXPOSURE VS READINESS

Young people use AI — but don't feel ready for it

Almost every young person already uses AI, mostly to study and to do work tasks. But familiarity hasn't become confidence: most have had no formal AI training, and few feel truly prepared for an AI-driven labour market.

94% at least somewhat familiar with AI weekly or more often

85%

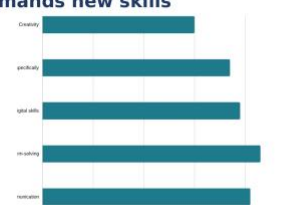


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THEME 3 - PERCEPTIONS & SKILLS

Everyone agrees AI demands new skills

AI is seen mainly as reshaping jobs rather than eliminating them outright. Youth rate the shift toward new skill demands at 3.89 out of 5 on average - the strongest point of agreement in the whole survey. Communication and problem-solving top the list of skills youth say matter most, ahead of narrow technical AI skills.



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TODAY'S WORLD CAFE

Four questions we'll explore together

1 AI and the Changing Workplace

Where is AI already changing jobs — and where is it creating opportunity?

2 Skills for the AI Era

What skills will young people need most in the next few years?

3 Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind

Who faces the greatest barriers, and what would make opportunities more equal?

4 Education and Training Gaps

Does education prepare you for the job market — and what's missing?

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5.4 World Café theme cards

The printed discussion cards used at the four thematic tables, carrying the guiding questions for each theme.

 WORLD CAFÉ
1  TABLE 1




AI and the Changing Workplace

AI is already reshaping how people work. Some jobs are changing, some are disappearing, and new ones are emerging.

DISCUSS:

- What changes are you already seeing in the job market because of AI?
- Which jobs or tasks do you think will change the most?
- Where do you see AI creating real opportunities for young people?
- What worries you most about these changes?




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 WORLD CAFÉ
2  TABLE 2




Skills for the AI Era

As workplaces change, so do the skills employers look for — both technical and human.

DISCUSS:

- Which skills will young people need most in the next few years?
- What are employers actually asking for today?
- Which skills are most young people currently missing?
- How could young people prepare themselves better?




PATHFINDER - GA 101253819 - WP4PATHFINDER-ICERV

 WORLD CAFÉ
3  TABLE 3




Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind

Not all young people have the same starting point. Some face greater barriers as AI reshapes the labour market.

DISCUSS:

- Which young people face the greatest difficulties finding or keeping a job?
- What are the main barriers they encounter - economic, geographic, educational, or otherwise?
- What would need to change for opportunities to be more equal?
- Who is responsible for making that happen?




PATHFINDER - GA 101253819 - WP4PATHFINDER-ICERV

 WORLD CAFÉ
4  TABLE 4




Education and Training Gaps

Education and training are supposed to prepare young people for the labour market — but gaps remain.

DISCUSS:

- Does education today prepare you for the job market? What's missing?
- What kind of training or education do young people need most?
- What new learning opportunities would actually be useful?
- How could employers help close this gap?




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5.5 World Café notes

Condensed transcription of the notes taken at the four thematic tables. The full transcription and the original photographed sheets are archived in the WP4 project records.

Table 1 — AI and the Changing Workplace

Changes seen: junior IT roles harder to land; graphic design oversupplied; salespeople replaced by machines; remote work widening access; ads and video losing ground to generative AI; higher expectations of entry-level candidates.

- **Jobs changing most:** administration and paperwork; medicine (more automated, seen as improving); marketing; art (seen as substitutable); archaeology (AI-assisted analysis); digital jobs generally.
- **Opportunities:** video editing; entrepreneurship and website creation; research and learning; job-search filtering; an internship case study built with AI; efficiency gains for AI-friendly, skilled people.
- **Worries:** job-market contraction; a shrinking middle class and rising disparities; environmental damage from data centres and water use; over-reliance creating mistakes and “becoming inhuman”; schools pressuring students to use AI too much; “if AI gains consciousness, will it be on our side?”

Table 2 — Skills for the AI Era

- **Skills needed:** critical thinking and media literacy (deepfakes); cybersecurity; emotional intelligence; adaptability; negotiation; practical skills; prompt engineering and AI literacy — knowing how and when to use it; English and communication; design thinking.
- **What employers ask vs what matters:** experience and degrees vs character, soft skills and interpersonal relationships; “can you think for yourself” — proactivity and independence.
- **Gaps observed:** attention span and face-to-face communication; self-reliance; information literacy; career counselling; over-reliance on AI.
- **What would help:** courses on AI basics, prompting and how it works; self-learning and active learning; mindfulness and “the art of waiting”; free resources; someone to teach “the AI behind the AI”; Erasmus+ projects and volunteering; using AI to teach better and to work with emotions.

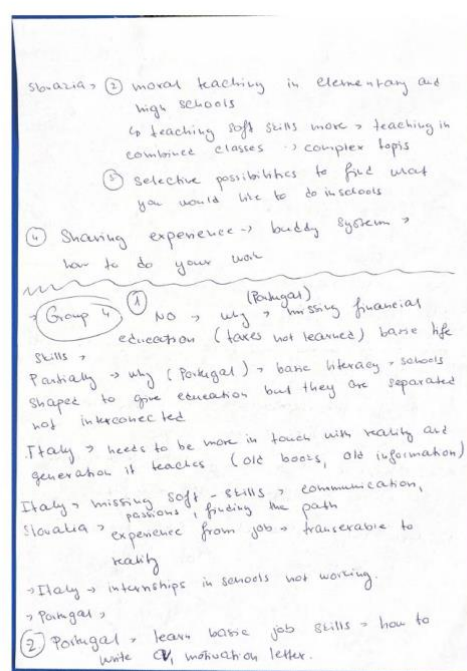
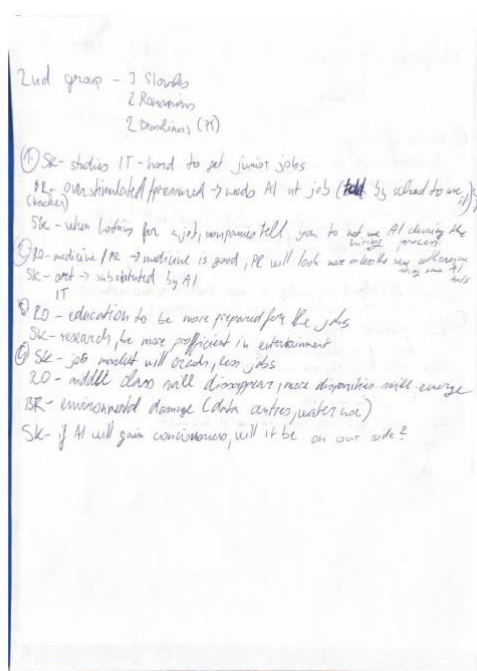
Table 3 — Youth at Risk of Being Left Behind.

- **Most at risk:** young people from families without education or resources; rural areas; excluded communities and minorities (Roma, people with disabilities); those without family support — “where you come from influences everything: family, education, democratic participation.”
- **Barriers:** internet, devices and community access; needing to earn instead of study; weaker schools and unsupported teachers in rural areas; migration; low social capital; mental-health struggles; over-education relative to available jobs.
- **What should change:** attention and investment in rural areas; better information systems; anti-discrimination measures and student quotas; inclusive education systems; free and accessible education; stipends and scholarships.
- **Who is responsible:** Ministry of Education; national government; EU institutions; youth organisations; schools; municipalities; and young people themselves — “every single one of us.”

Table 4 — Education and Training Gaps

- **Does education prepare you?** No or only partially — outdated books and information; subjects taught in silos; missing financial education (taxes never taught) and basic life skills; internships in schools not working; theory over experience.
- **Training needed most:** CV and motivation-letter writing; soft skills taught from elementary level, including in combined classes on complex topics; STEM modernisation balanced with character education; teacher training in soft skills.
- **Useful new opportunities:** selective in-school options to explore interests; buddy systems transferring experience person-to-person; non-formal education and Erasmus+ exchanges; regular in-job courses.
- **Employers' role:** drop unrealistic experience requirements for entry roles; count school and university experience (with proper, paid internships); protect young workers from exploitative placements; share experience through mentoring.

Sample of the original photographed table notes:



5.6 Baseline survey instrument — Youth

The Slovak-language youth questionnaire (Google Forms), including the GDPR consent section.

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PATHFINDER - Participatory Research
https://docs.google.com/forms/u/1/d/1Ro3FI-Y3yCR7fkp1OySQvLXc...

PATHFINDER - Participatory Research

Phase 1 of the PATHFINDER project adopts a **Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR)** framework to co-produce knowledge on the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on youth labour market participation. This approach aligns with the principles of participatory action research as a **collaborative, cyclical process of planning, action, and reflection**, aimed not only at generating knowledge but also at enabling social change. In this sense, the research process is not extractive but **transformative**, positioning young people as co-researchers who investigate structural conditions affecting their lives and contribute to shaping responses.

You may find more information regarding the survey [in this document](#) and the [Information on the Processing of Personal Data](#)

* Indicates required question

Section 0 : GDPR

1. **Confirmation of age and eligibility** - I confirm that I am at least 18 years old and eligible to participate in this survey. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No (if 'No' is selected, the survey ends)

2. **Confirmation of having read the privacy notice** - I have read and understood the information provided above on how my personal data will be processed. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

3. **Consent to participate and to the processing of personal data** - I freely consent to participate in the PATHFINDER baseline survey and to the processing of my responses for the research purposes described above. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes, I consent

☐ No, I do not consent (if 'No' is selected, the survey ends)

Section 1: Profile and Background

Purpose: Enables cross-country comparison and identification of inequality patterns.

4. **Age:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ 18–21

☐ 22–25

☐ 26–30

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PATHFINDER - Participatory Research
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5. **Gender:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Female

☐ Male

☐ Non-binary / other

☐ Prefer not to say

6. **Current status:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Unemployed

☐ Employed (full-time / part-time)

☐ Student

☐ Not in employment, education or training (NEET)

☐ Prefer not to say

7. **Highest level of education:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Secondary

☐ Vocational

☐ Bachelor

☐ Master or above

8. **Country/region:** *

9. **Which best describes the area where you live?**

Mark only one oval.

☐ Large city

☐ Small town

☐ Rural area/village

☐ Prefer not to say

10. **Do you consider that you have experienced specific conditions that place you at a disadvantage compared to others of a similar age or background?** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

11. If yes, please indicate which of the following apply to you (you may select more than one or skip the question):

Check all that apply:

- ☐ Disabilities (e.g. physical, mental, intellectual or sensory impairments)
☐ Health problems (e.g. chronic diseases, severe illnesses, or other physical or mental health conditions)
☐ Barriers related to education and training systems (e.g. learning difficulties, early school leaving, NEET status, or structural limitations in education)
☐ Cultural differences (e.g. migrant or refugee background, minority status, language barriers, or cultural integration challenges)
☐ Economic barriers (e.g. low income, financial difficulties, unemployment, poverty, or dependence on social welfare)
☐ Barriers related to discrimination (e.g. based on gender, age, ethnicity, religion, beliefs, sexual orientation, disability or intersectional factors)
☐ Geographical barriers (e.g. living in rural, remote, underserved, or less developed areas)

Section 2: Awareness and Use of AI

Rationale: AI knowledge is unevenly distributed among youth, affecting perceptions and opportunities

12. How familiar are you with AI-based tools and systems (such as ChatGPT, recommendation systems, or AI-assisted platforms)? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Very familiar
☐ Somewhat familiar
☐ Heard of them, but do not use them
☐ Not familiar at all
☐ Not sure

13. How often do you use AI tools? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Daily
☐ Weekly
☐ Rarely
☐ Never

14. For what purposes do you use AI? (multiple choice) *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Learning / studying
☐ Job search
☐ Work tasks
☐ Content creation
☐ I do not use AI
☐ Other (please specify in the next field)

15. If you chose other, you can specify

16. How confident are you in your understanding of how to use AI? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Very confident
☐ Somewhat confident
☐ Not confident

Section 3: Perceptions of AI and Employment

Rationale: Surveys show strong uncertainty and mixed expectations about AI's labour market impact

To what extent do you agree:

17. AI will create new job opportunities for young people *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
 Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly agree

18. AI will replace many jobs currently available to youth *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
 Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly agree

19. AI will increase inequality in the labour market *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
 Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly agree

20. AI will require new types of skills *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
 Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly agree

21. Which sectors do you think are most affected by AI? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ IT / digital
☐ Administration
☐ Manufacturing
☐ Creative industries
☐ Services (retail, hospitality)
☐ Other

22. If other, please specify

23. In your opinion, to what extent are the following groups of youth at risk due to AI? *

Mark only one oval per row.

	Not at risk at all	Somewhat at risk	Neutral	At risk	Highly at risk
Low-skilled youth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Rural youth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Young women	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Young minorities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 4: Personal Experience and Exposure

Rationale: Captures lived experience for mapping exercises.

24. Have you experienced AI affecting your employment or education? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes (positively)

☐ Yes (negatively)

☐ No

☐ Not sure

25. If AI has affected your education, work or job search, please briefly describe how. (GDPR: "Please do not include names of individuals, employers, or any other information that could identify a specific person in your answer.")

Section 5: Skills and Preparedness

Rationale: Skills gaps are central in AI labour market research

26. How prepared do you feel for an AI-driven labour market? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Very prepared

☐ Somewhat prepared

☐ Not prepared

27. Which skills do you think are most important for the labour market? (max 3) *

Check all that apply.

☐ Digital skills

☐ AI skills

☐ Critical thinking

☐ Creativity

☐ Communication

☐ Problem-solving

☐ Adaptability

28. Have you had access to training in AI? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

29. If yes, please specify the training provider

30. What barriers prevent you from developing these skills? (select all that apply) *

Check all that apply.

☐ Lack of access to training

☐ Financial barriers

☐ Lack of time

☐ Lack of information

☐ Limited opportunities in my area

☐ * Lack of equipment/internet

☐ Other

☐ No barriers encountered

Section 6: Expectations for the Event

31. If you have the opportunity to attend an event with employers, which topics would you like to discuss? *

Section 7: Final Reflection

32. In one sentence: What is the biggest challenge AI creates for young people? *

33. In one sentence: What is the biggest opportunity AI creates for young people? *

34. In one sentence, what is the most important thing that should be done to support young people in an AI-driven labour market? By whom? *

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Google Forms

5.7 Baseline survey instrument — Employers

The Slovak-language employer questionnaire (Google Forms), including the GDPR consent section.

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PATHFINDER - Participatory Research

Phase 1 of the PATHFINDER project adopts a **Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR)** framework to co-produce knowledge on the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on youth labour market participation. This approach aligns with the principles of participatory action research as a **collaborative, cyclical process of planning, action, and reflection**, aimed not only at generating knowledge but also at enabling social change. In this sense, the research process is not extractive but **transformative**, positioning young people as co-researchers who investigate structural conditions affecting their lives and contribute to shaping responses.

You may find more information regarding the survey [in this document](#) and the [Information on the Processing of Personal Data](#)

* Indicates required question.

1. **Confirmation of age and eligibility** - I confirm that I am at least 18 years old and eligible to participate in this survey. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No (if 'No' is selected, the survey ends)

2. **Confirmation of having read the privacy notice** - I have read and understood the information provided above on how my personal data will be processed. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

3. **Consent to participate and to the processing of personal data** - I freely consent to participate in the PATHFINDER baseline survey and to the processing of my responses for the research purposes described above. *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No, I do not consent (if 'No' is selected, the survey ends)

Section 1: Organisational Profile

Purpose: Enables cross-country and sectoral comparison.

4. **Sector:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ IT / digital

☐ Manufacturing

☐ Services (retail, hospitality, etc.)

☐ Public sector

☐ Creative industries

☐ NGO/CSO, ...

☐ Other

5. **If other, please specify:** *

6. **Organisation size:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Micro (1–9 employees)

☐ Small (10–49)

☐ Medium (50–249)

☐ Large (250+)

7. **Country / region**

8. **Role in organisation:** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ HR / recruitment

☐ Owner / director

☐ Senior/Middle management

☐ Team leader/supervisor

☐ Other

Section 2: Awareness and Use of AI

Rationale: Captures employer exposure to AI and organisational readiness.

9. **Does your organisation currently use AI tools?** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes (extensively)

☐ Yes (limited use)

☐ No

10. **How would you assess your organisation's understanding of how to use AI?** *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Very strong

☐ Moderate

☐ Limited

Section 3: Perceptions of AI and Employment

Rationale: Enables direct comparison with youth perceptions.

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3 x 11 06/06/2026, 11:55 4 x 11 06/06/2026, 11:55

11. To what extent do you agree? *

Mark only one oval per row.

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
AI will create new job opportunities for young people	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
AI-based recruitment systems may create unfair outcomes for some young people.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
AI will replace many entry-level jobs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
AI will increase productivity in your sector	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
AI will increase inequality in the labour market	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

12. How do you expect AI to affect hiring in your organisation in the next 5 years? *
(select all that apply)

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Increase hiring
☐ Reduce hiring
☐ Change skill requirements
☐ No major change
☐ Other

13. If other, please specify:

Section 4: Experience with Youth Employment

Rationale: Provides real labour market insights for participatory mapping.

14. How would you assess the employability of young people today? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Very high
☐ Moderate
☐ Low

5 x 11

06/06/2026, 11:55 6 x 11

06/06/2026, 11:55

15. What are the main challenges when hiring young people? (select up to 3) *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Lack of skills
☐ Lack of experience
☐ Mismatch between education and job needs
☐ Lack of motivation
☐ Limited digital/AI skills
☐ Other
☐ No challenges encountered when hiring young people

16. Have you observed changes in youth employment due to AI? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes (positive)
☐ Yes (negative)
☐ No
☐ Not sure

17. What changes related to AI have you observed in youth employment? (Select all that apply)

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Increased demand for digital skills
☐ Reduced need for some entry-level tasks
☐ Greater productivity expectations
☐ More flexible/hybrid work
☐ Increased need for continuous learning
☐ No major changes observed
☐ Other

18. If other, please specify:

Section 5: Skills and Preparedness

Rationale: Identifies gaps between supply (youth) and demand (employers).

19. Which skills are most important for young employees in the AI era? (max 3)

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Digital skills
☐ AI skills
☐ Problem-solving
☐ Communication
☐ Adaptability
☐ Creativity
☐ Teamwork

20. How well prepared are young people in these skills?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Very well prepared
☐ Moderately prepared
☐ Not prepared

7 x 11

06/06/2026, 11:55 8 x 11

06/06/2026, 11:55

21. Does your organisation provide training in AI or digital skills?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

22. What are the main barriers to hiring or training young people? (Select up to 3) *

Check all that apply:

- ☐ Lack of technical/digital skills
- ☐ Lack of practical experience
- ☐ Limited time/resources for training
- ☐ Rapid technological change
- ☐ Mismatch between education and labour market needs
- ☐ Limited motivation or retention
- ☐ Financial constraints
- ☐ Other
- ☐ No barriers encountered

23. If other, please specify:

Section 8: Expectations for Dialogue

24. If you have the opportunity to attend an event with youth, which topics would you like to discuss?

Section 9: Final Reflection

25. In one sentence: What is the biggest challenge AI creates for youth employment? *

26. In one sentence: What is the biggest opportunity AI creates for youth employment? *

27. In one sentence, what is the most important thing that should be done to support young people in an AI-driven labour market? By whom? *

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Google Forms

5.8 Selected responses — Youth survey (n = 30)

All 30 Slovak youth responses, collected online and in person around the dialogue event using the same instrument. Respondents were 23 women and 7 men; 15 were aged 26–30, 9 aged 18–21 and 6 aged 22–25.

How familiar are you with AI-based tools and systems?	
Very familiar	15 (50%)
Somewhat familiar	14 (47%)
Have heard of them but do not use them	1 (3%)
Not familiar	0

How often do you use AI tools?	
Daily	18 (60%)
Weekly	8 (27%)
Rarely	3 (10%)
Never	1 (3%)

How confident are you in your understanding of how to use AI?	
Very confident	11 (37%)
Somewhat confident	18 (60%)
Not confident at all	1 (3%)

Perceptions of AI and employment (mean, 1 = strongly disagree ... 5 = strongly agree)	
AI will create new job opportunities for young people	2.7
AI will replace many jobs currently available to youth	3.6
AI will increase inequality in the labour market	3.6
AI will require new types of skills	3.9

How prepared do you feel for an AI-driven labour market?	
Very prepared	7 (23%)
Somewhat prepared	13 (43%)
Not prepared	10 (33%)

Have you had access to training in AI?	
Yes	12 (40%)
No	18 (60%)

Have you experienced AI affecting your employment or education?	
Yes, positively	12 (40%)

Yes, negatively	6 (20%)
Not sure	10 (33%)
No	2 (7%)

Do you consider that you have experienced disadvantaging circumstances?	
Yes	18 (60%)
No	12 (40%)
Most cited	geographical barriers (9), economic barriers (7), discrimination-related barriers (5)

Which skills do you consider most important for the labour market? (max. 3)	
Problem-solving	18
Critical thinking	16
Adaptability	13
Communication	12
Digital skills	12
AI skills	10
Creativity	9

What prevents you from developing these skills?	
Financial barriers	12
Limited opportunities where I live	10
No access to training	9
Lack of time	9
Lack of information	8
No barriers experienced	5
Lack of equipment or internet	3

5.9 Selected responses — Employer survey (n = 30)

Does your organisation currently use AI tools?	
Yes, extensively	10 (33%)
Yes, to a limited extent	17 (57%)
No	3 (10%)

How would you assess your organisation's understanding of how to use AI?	
Very strong	13 (43%)
Moderate	13 (43%)
Limited	4 (13%)

Employer perceptions of AI (mean, 1 = strongly disagree ... 5 = strongly agree)	
AI will create new job opportunities for young people	3.9
AI-based recruitment systems can create unfair outcomes	3.6
AI will replace many entry-level positions	3.2
AI will increase productivity in my sector	4.0
AI will increase inequality in the labour market	3.3

How do you expect AI to affect hiring in your organisation over the next 5 years?	
Will change skill requirements	17 (57%)
No significant change	8 (27%)
Will reduce recruitment	4 (13%)
Will increase recruitment	1 (3%)

How would you assess the employability of young people today?	
Very high	3 (10%)
Moderate	19 (63%)
Low	8 (27%)

How well prepared are young people in the skills that matter?	
Very well prepared	1 (3%)
Moderately prepared	24 (80%)
Not prepared	5 (17%)

Have you noticed changes in the employment of young people because of AI?	
Yes, positively	5 (17%)

Yes, negatively	5 (17%)
No	7 (23%)
Not sure	13 (43%)

Does your organisation provide training in AI or digital skills?	
Yes	16 (53%)
No	14 (47%)

In their open answers, employers converged on over-reliance on AI without a critical filter, the rapid change of required skills, and the automation of simple entry-level tasks as the biggest challenges for young people — and on education, ethical codes of use, critical thinking and adaptability as the most important support.